First Point Physio Ltd

First contact physiotherapist services

About Us

We've been proudly partnering with Primary Care Networks (PCNs) across the UK since July 2017. We are one of the most dedicated and longest-running companies in the country providing first contact Physiotherapists in GP surgeries, and therefore bring a wealth of experience.

We are comprised of over 50 clinicians and have clinics in over 120 GP surgeries.

What we do

We see patients with suspected musculoskeletal (MSK) conditions, rather than them seeing a GP, working alongside the primary care team with the aim to reduce pressure on GP's .

A first contact physiotherapist (FCP) is a fully qualified, experienced physiotherapist who is able to assess, diagnose and manage patients with a range of MSK conditions and screen for non-MSK conditions. They have undertaken enhanced and advanced training and have to follow the highest clinical and professional standards. They are also registered with the Health and Care Professions Council.

Our Impact

MSK health issues are the most common cause of repeat GP appointments and research has shown that up to 30% of a GPs caseload at any one time is comprised of musculoskeletal complaints. Most of them can be dealt with effectively by a physiotherapist without any need to see the GP.

MSK is the second largest cause of sickness absence; speeding up access to a physio will reduce this.

How we can help

If you're seeking support for your primary care network (PCN) or your GP surgery through the additional roles reimbursement scheme (ARRS), we offer qualified professionals to meet your needs within the .

Our team is ready to integrate seamlessly into your practice, helping to enhance patient care while reducing the workload of GPs and other healthcare professionals.

We understand that adaptability is essential to meet the ever-changing requirements of your PCN. Whether it's offering in surgery face to face appointments, enhanced access service., facilitating online consultations, or delivering remote services, we're here to provide the support you need, whenever and wherever you need it.

We offer customised service packages designed to meet the needs of all our practices.

LET'S *connect*

Get in touch – set up a meeting

We would love the opportunity to discuss with you our first contact physiotherapist services and give you more details about what we can provide to you.

Please book a time in my calendar that's convenient for you here.

Telephone

Phillip Dale (Director) 07731526103

Online Meeting

Book a time in our calendar here

Website

www.firstpointphysio.co.uk

E-Mail

info@firstpointphysio.co.uk

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How does it work?

1. Patient contacts their GP Surgery regarding an issue.
2. Care navigator or triage clinician determines it is a MSK issue.
3. Care navigator books patient into the FCP diary on the surgery's patient system.
4. FCP assesses and triages the patient for red flags/serious pathology and ensures the condition is MSK in origin. We keep our notes within the GP surgery's patient system.
5. Patient is then either
   - given advice and exercises where appropriate and encouraged to self manage.
   - referred to Physiotherapy, further investigations, secondary care or other specialist services.
6. Exercises are given to patients through PhysioTec.
   We are also working in partnership with DocHQ to provide AI to help patients perform exercises accurately at home.
7. Follow up appointments are available where necessary and depending on the needs of the practice.

What are the benefits of having an FCP?

For Patients

- No long waiting times to see an NHS Physiotherapist in a hospital.
- Seeing the right person at the right time, first time.
- Less likelihood of acute conditions becoming chronic.
- Enhancing patient care and reducing lead times fosters a more positive experience for patients. With the Specialist FCP providing clear explanations of their condition, patients feel reassured and gain a better understanding of their health.
- Faster recovery.
- Thorough assessment, diagnosis and planning of treatment of any MSK conditions – typically appointments are at least twice as long as a GP appointment.
- Easier access to MSK knowledge and skills.

For GPs/PCNs

- Removing burdensome MSK caseload from overworked GPs.
- Ability to reduce costs associated with GP capacity.
- Reduction in cost of prescriptions.
- Reception staff able to triage and book appointments directly.
- Small number of patients referred onwards to secondary Care or back to GPs.
- Reduction in waiting times.
- FCPs are autonomous and can manage their own caseload.
- Integration into Practice/ PCN workforce.
- Can help to fulfill the Enhanced Access Service.
- Help with MSK training for practice staff.
- More use of Imaging and investigations.

FCP in Numbers

- 80% of patients consulting the FCP reported not needing to visit their GP for the same problem.
- 95% of patients received sufficient information from their FCP on self-care relating to their MSK problem.
- 94% would recommend the FCP service to family and friends.

From the National Evaluation of First Contact Practitioner (FCP) model of primary care report.

What sets First Point Physio Apart

We provide a thoroughly managed service for Primary Care Networks (PCNs), enabling you to consistently deliver a top-notch first contact physiotherapy service to all your member practices.

Personalised Service

At First Point Physio, our role as a small, agile provider allows us to offer a highly personalised service model that is thoughtfully aligned with the operational and clinical priorities of each Primary Care Network we assist. We collaborate closely with our partners to ensure that every facet of our service is responsive, adaptable, and customised to meet the unique needs of their member practices. This tailored approach enables us to integrate smoothly with existing teams and consistently deliver high-quality care.

Clinical Development

We take full responsibility for the ongoing training and clinical development of our staff. All clinicians are supported through structured professional development pathways and remain up to date with current best practice and regulatory standards. This ensures service quality and clinical governance are maintained, without placing additional administrative or supervisory demands on our partners.

Performance reporting

We also provide regular performance reporting as part of our managed service. These reports offer clear insights into service delivery, clinician activity, and patient outcomes, enabling PCNs to monitor impact and ensure alignment with contractual and clinical objectives. Our reporting framework supports governance, facilitates informed decision-making, and helps demonstrate value across member practices.

Responsive Communication

We maintain responsive, solution-focused communication to ensure any queries or concerns are addressed promptly and professionally. Our team is proactive in troubleshooting issues, minimising disruption and supporting seamless service continuity for all partner practices.

Fully Funded within ARRS

Our service is fully encompassed in our pricing and is completely refundable within the limits of the additional roles reimbursement scheme.

Telephone

Phillip Dale (Director) 07731526103

Online Meeting

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EXAMPLE OF MONTHLY FCP DATA

BESPOKE TO EACH PCN WE SUPPORT

EXAMPLE PCN

MONTHLY FIRST CONTACT PHYSIOTHERAPY REPORT
MARCH 2025

Introduction

The report below offers an overview from March 2025 of the performance of the first contact practitioner service.

This information is self-reported by clinicians and is designed to provide readers with a clear understanding of the service's utilisation, appropriateness, and outcomes, all aimed at facilitating feedback and service development.

315
Consultations

5:1
Follow up Ratio

5.44%
DNA Percentage

98%
Utilisation

1
Whole Time Equivalent FCP

87%
Were managed within the service with no need for onward referral

1%
Needed a follow up with a GP

<1%
Needed an Injection

1.5%
Required Imaging

Appointments

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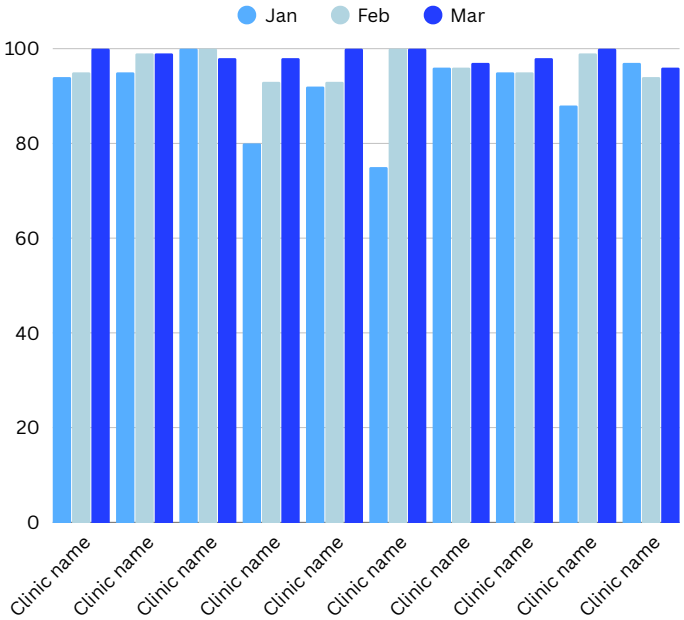
Urgent Face-to-Face appointments are available within the next week.
Routine Face-to-Face appointments have an average 2-week wait.
Telephone appointments are available within the week.

ALL CLINIC SNAPSHOT
MONTHLY FIRST CONTACT PHYSIOTHERAPY REPORT
MARCH 2025

Utilisation %



Utilisation %	Jan	Feb	Mar
Clinic name	94	95	100
Clinic name	95	99	99
Clinic name	100	100	98
Clinic name	80	93	98
Clinic name	92	93	100
Clinic name	75	100	100
Clinic name	96	96	97
Clinic name	95	95	98
Clinic name	88	99	100
Clinic name	97	94	96

Consultations Monthly Comparison

	Jan	Feb	Mar
Total Consults	651	597	585
Total DNA	64	56	54

	Jan	Feb	Mar
Imaging required	1.5%	2%	1%
Injection requested	1%	2%	2%
GP follow up	1%	1%	1%

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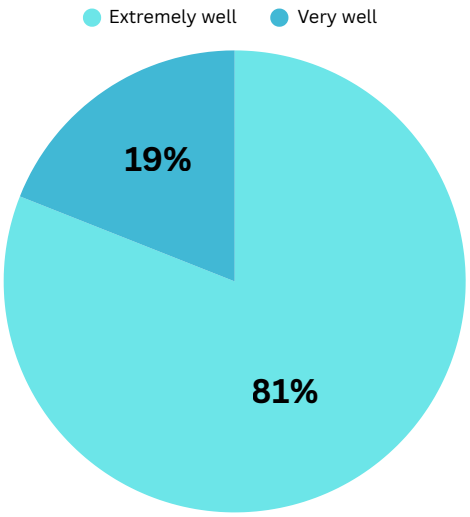
PATIENT FEEDBACK
MONTHLY FIRST CONTACT PHYSIOTHERAPY REPORT
MARCH 2025

Introduction

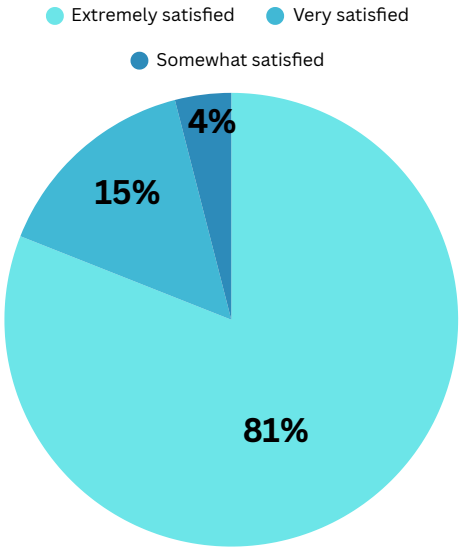
The report below offers an overview from March 2025 of the patient feedback regarding the first contact practitioner service.

This information is taken from a survey we ask patients to complete after their appointment, designed to help us continue to improve the care we provide to our patients.

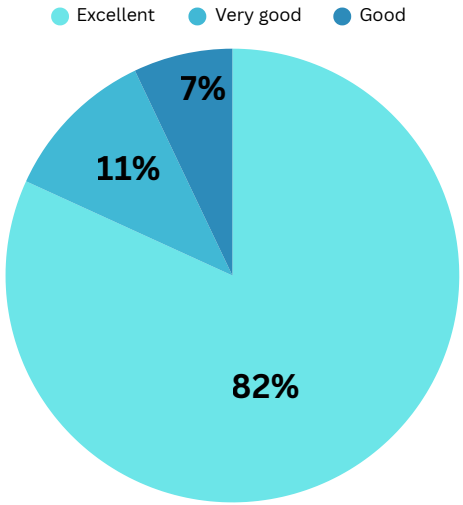
How well did the First Contact Physiotherapy (FCP) listen to your needs?



Overall, how satisfied were you with your last FCP appointment with us?



Overall, how would you rate the FCP service you received with us?



Patient Comment:

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